

Uddhav P. Gautam

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July 11, 2026

Search Committee, Information Assurance Manager
Office of Export and Secure Research Compliance
Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, Virginia

Re: Information Assurance Manager (Requisition 536294)

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Information Assurance Manager position with the Office of Export and Secure Research Compliance (Requisition 536294). I am a U.S. citizen and a member of the U.S. Army Reserve; I previously held a Secret clearance and am eligible to obtain the Top Secret/SCI clearance, with CI or polygraph, that this role requires. I am based in Blacksburg as a PhD researcher at Virginia Tech, so I can work fully onsite and meet the 60-minute emergency-response requirement.

My work is in security and systems. My research spans software supply-chain security, the Linux kernel and eBPF, embedded and IoT security, and digital forensics, and several parts map directly to this role. I work in data forensics and recovery with Cellebrite UFED and MVT, and in network and system monitoring with Elasticsearch, Logstash, and Filebeat, eBPF tracing, and operational-technology monitoring published in *IEEE Transactions on Smart Grid*. For four years I was a system and network administrator, managing Windows and Linux systems, networks, deployment, and hardware, and I hold multiple Microsoft certifications from that work.

The role centers on policy, documentation, and accreditation. As an architect and technical lead, I built the engineering standards, architecture documentation, and process guidance that kept a regulated platform compliant, and I have created and delivered instructional material as a university instructor. I have applied NIST-aligned security practices in my DevSecOps and supply-chain work, including SBOMs, SARIF, and reproducible builds. I am ready to certify and ramp quickly on the classified-industrial-security specifics this position requires — NISPOM, the RMF accreditation process, ICDs, and eMASS — including the DoD 8570 IAM certifications such as Security+ CE and CISSP. My military service and prior clearance mean I already understand the discipline and trust these environments demand.

I would welcome the chance to discuss how my security background, clearance eligibility, and on-site availability in Blacksburg fit the Industrial Security Program's mission of protecting classified and controlled research. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Uddhav P. Gautam